

The Nashville Luxury Home *Buyer's Guide*

A private-client roadmap to acquiring a \$2M+ home in Middle Tennessee.

2026 EDITION

PRESENTED BY

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FOREWORD

A welcome to Nashville's most coveted addresses.

Middle Tennessee has quietly become one of the most consequential luxury markets in the country. The migration of capital, talent, and taste from California, the Northeast, and the Midwest has reshaped what a luxury home in Nashville looks like — and what it demands of the buyer who pursues it.

This guide is built for the discerning buyer. It is the same playbook I use with relocating executives, founders, performers, and multi-generational families who expect their advisor to know the off-market house before it ever hits the MLS — and to manage every detail with the discretion the price tag deserves.

On the pages that follow you'll find the current state of the \$2M+ market, deep-dive profiles of the neighborhoods that matter, the seven-step process I run for every client, and the checklists and contacts that prevent costly missteps. When you're ready, my team and I are here.

A NOTE FROM JASON

“A luxury transaction is rarely about the highest bid. It's about the cleanest terms, the quietest negotiation, and the relationships that get a buyer through a door no one else can open.”

\$2.8M

MEDIAN LUXURY SALE 2026 YTD

+3-5%

FORECAST PRICE GROWTH 2026

0%

TN STATE INCOME TAX

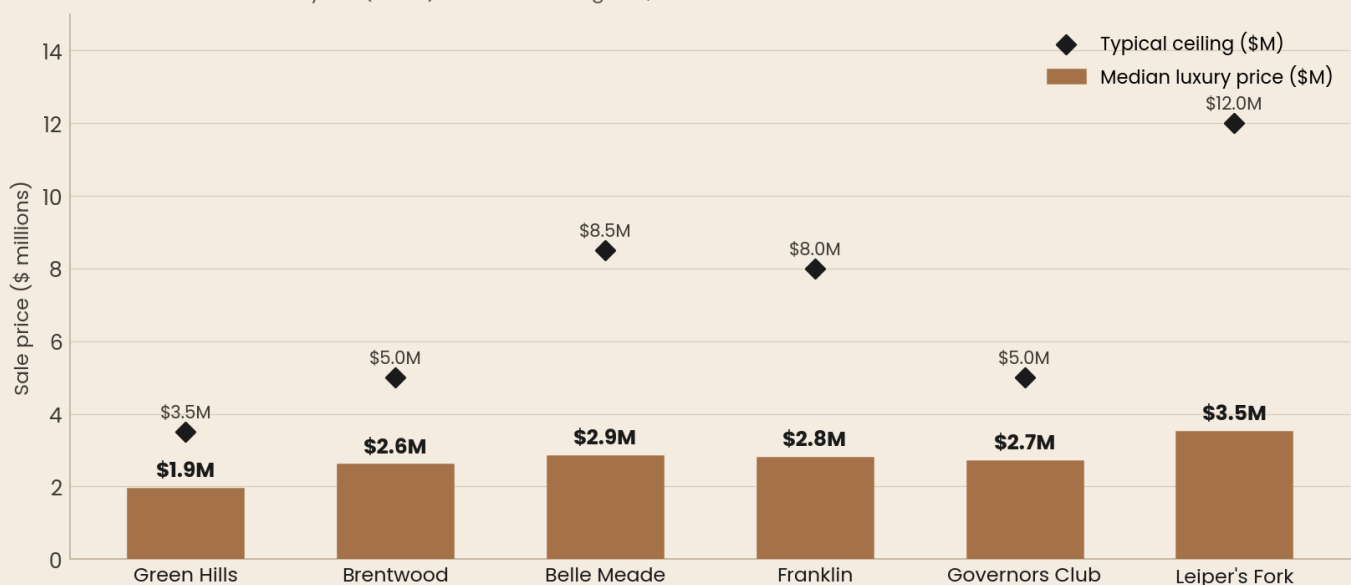
SECTION ONE

The 2026 market, at a glance.

Middle Tennessee's luxury tier (\$2M+) entered 2026 with the most robust selection of inventory since 2014 — a 13% YoY expansion — but the very best estates still trade quickly and quietly. The balance has shifted just enough for sophisticated buyers to negotiate with leverage, without yet flipping into a buyer's market.

Luxury median + typical ceiling, by submarket

Middle Tennessee · luxury tier (\$2M+) · MLS-derived figures, 2026 YTD



Read the chart: Median sale prices in the luxury tier have converged in the \$2.6M–\$2.9M band across in-town submarkets, while ceiling prices reveal the real story — Belle Meade and Franklin regularly trade homes above \$8M, and Leiper's Fork's estate market reaches \$10M–\$30M for celebrity-grade compounds.

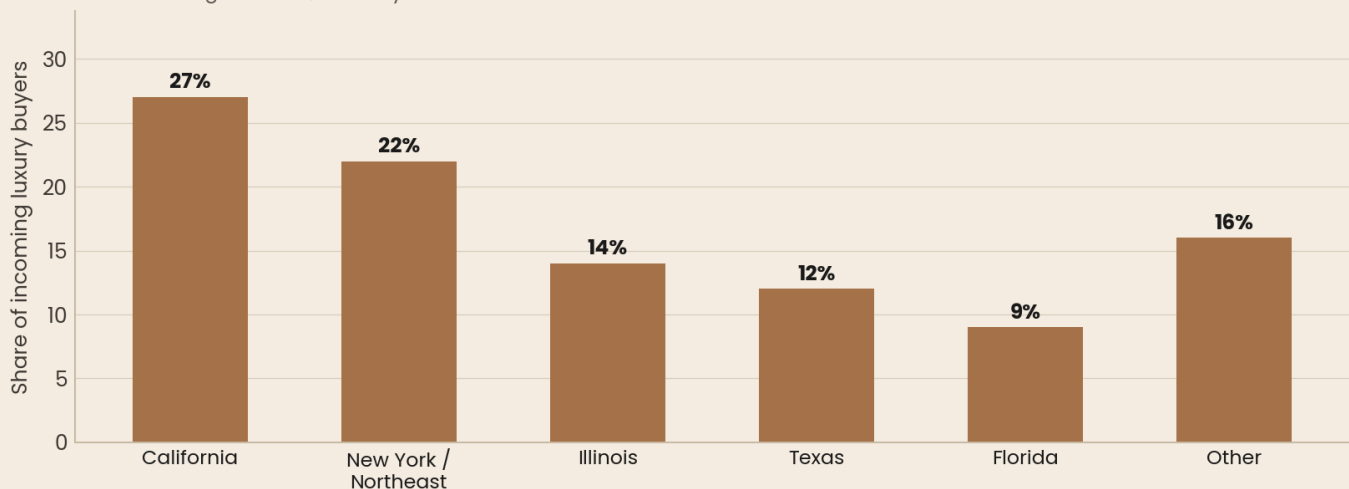
SECTION ONE (CONT.)

Who is buying Middle Tennessee.

The buyer pool has changed dramatically since 2020. Today, the majority of \$2M+ purchases in Williamson and Davidson counties involve someone moving in — not someone moving up.

Where Middle TN's luxury buyers are coming from

Estimated origin mix of \$2M+ buyers · 2025–2026



Who they are: Tech founders and operators exiting California; senior finance professionals leaving New York and Chicago; private-business owners and physicians from the Midwest; entertainment industry families coming for the music economy. Roughly 26% of recent movers work fully remotely; another 19% are hybrid, traveling occasionally to offices elsewhere.

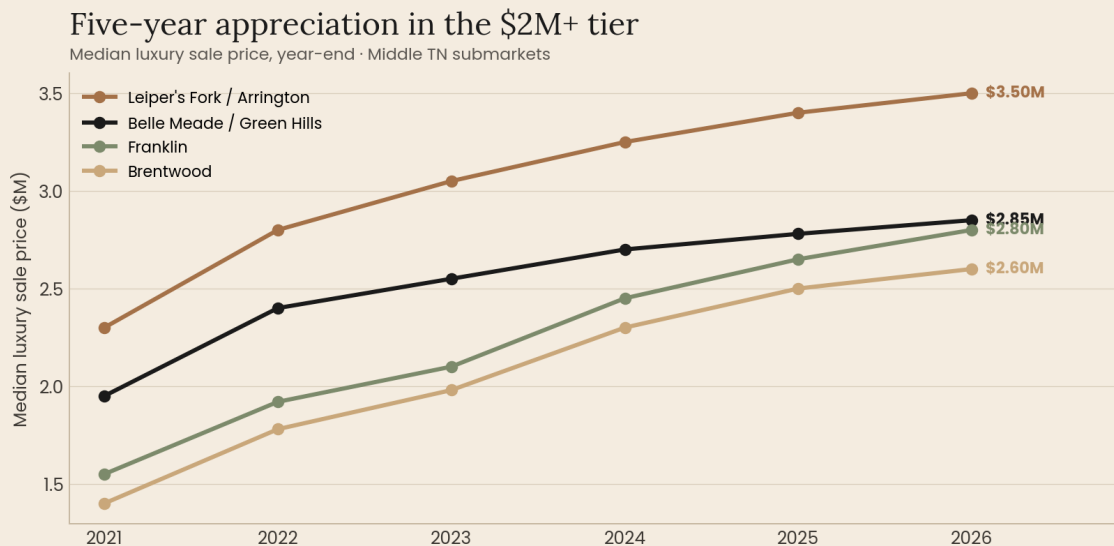
What they want: Single-family estates with land, privacy, modern infrastructure (fiber, EV, geothermal), proximity to top private schools, and access to a private club. They are well-advised, time-constrained, and decisive when the right property appears.

A NOTE FROM JASON

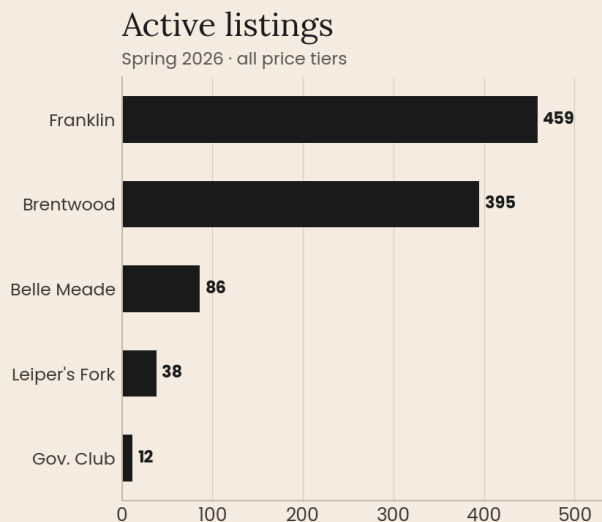
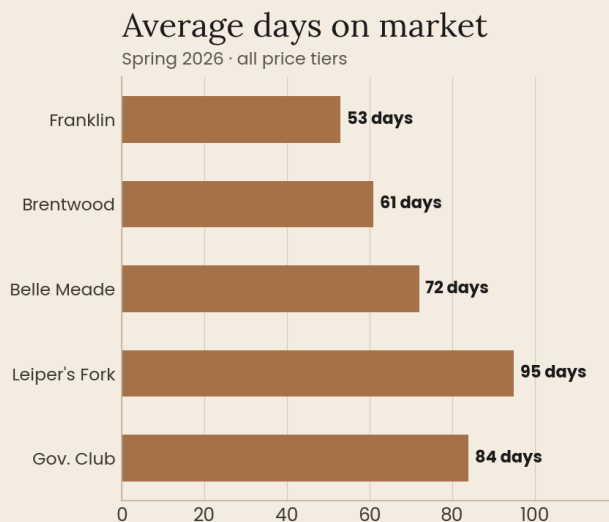
“A relocating buyer typically has 30 to 60 days to find a home before their next chapter starts. My job is to make sure that timeline doesn't force a compromise on the home itself.”

SECTION ONE (CONT.)

Where prices have gone — and where they are headed.



Since 2021 the \$2M+ tier has appreciated 35–80% across the four primary submarkets. Growth has cooled to a steadier 3–5% projected for 2026 as new inventory comes online — a healthier, longer-cycle market that rewards patient, well-advised buyers.



What this means for you: Average days on market has lengthened, but the most desirable homes — turnkey new builds, properties on premier streets, and estates with acreage — still transact in under 30 days, often with multiple offers. The market is moving on two tracks, and the right representation is the difference between winning a generational property and watching it sell to someone else.

SECTION TWO

What defines luxury in Middle Tennessee.

In a market where a single street can hold \$1.5M new builds and \$15M estates, 'luxury' is defined less by price and more by the combination of *land, light, craftsmanship, and lifestyle*. The list below is what my buyers consistently weigh.

- **Architectural distinction** — named architects, transitional or modern Southern designs, intentional siting on the lot.
- **Bespoke craftsmanship** — quarter-sawn millwork, honed-stone surfaces, custom steel and glass.
- **Outdoor program** — saltwater pools, covered loggias, outdoor kitchens, fireplaces, sport courts, equestrian facilities.
- **Smart-home integration** — Lutron / Crestron / Control4 tied to lighting, shades, audio, security, EV charging.
- **Privacy & security** — gated entries, perimeter fencing, camera systems, monitored alarms, mature landscape screening.
- **Wellness & sustainability** — spa baths, home gyms, geothermal HVAC, solar with battery backup, low-VOC finishes.
- **Secondary spaces** — wine rooms, golf simulators, theaters, guest quarters, dedicated home offices and podcast studios.
- **Location DNA** — proximity to a top private school, a country club, or a marquee retail/dining corridor.

A NOTE FROM JASON

“Buyers regularly tell me they could find any one of these features elsewhere. The reason they buy a Middle Tennessee home is that, here, they can have all of them — on the right street — for a fraction of what the same lifestyle costs in Los Angeles, Manhattan, or Miami.”

SECTION THREE

Where to buy in 2026.

Each Middle Tennessee submarket has its own character, price discipline, and resale rhythm. Below is the version of this story I tell my private clients.

WILLIAMSON COUNTY · 30 MIN SOUTH OF DOWNTOWN

Franklin

Williamson County's anchor: historic Main Street, a top-rated school system, and a deep bench of master-planned communities. Franklin trades volume and prestige in roughly equal measure, with strong resale liquidity across price points.

\$2.8M	\$8M+	\$525	53 days
MEDIAN LUXURY	TYPICAL CEILING	PRICE / SQ FT	AVG DAYS ON MKT

WHAT BUYERS LOVE

- **Westhaven** — Arthur Hills golf course, resort amenities, walkable village center.
- **LaurelBrooke** — gated estates on 1+ acre lots, consistently in the \$2–5M band.
- **Downtown Franklin** — historic district homes with verandas and walkable charm.
- **Berry Farms / McEwen** — newer master-planned, townhome through estate options.

WILLIAMSON COUNTY · 20 MIN SOUTH OF DOWNTOWN

Brentwood

Family-focused, country-club anchored, and home to Middle Tennessee's most prestigious private school cluster. About 27% of Brentwood closings are now in the \$2M+ tier.

\$2.6M	\$5M+	\$485	61 days
MEDIAN LUXURY	TYPICAL CEILING	PRICE / SQ FT	AVG DAYS ON MKT

WHAT BUYERS LOVE

- **Governors Club** — Arnold Palmer signature course, guard-gated, avg list ~\$2.7M.
- **Annandale** — English-village inspired enclave, limited inventory, exceptional resale.
- **Hampton Reserve / Taramore** — newer-construction estate communities.
- **Old Hickory Blvd. corridor** — mature 1–3 acre lots, iconic Brentwood addresses.

SECTION THREE (CONT.)

In-town & estate country.

DAVIDSON COUNTY · 10 MIN FROM DOWNTOWN

Belle Meade

Nashville's most established old-money address — a 3.1 sq mile incorporated city with its own police force, top public schools, and the historic Belle Meade Country Club. Inventory is scarce; 61% of sales are in the \$1.5–4M 'core' band and 22% trade above \$4M.

\$2.9M

MEDIAN LUXURY

\$8.5M+

TYPICAL CEILING

\$620

PRICE / SQ FT

72 days

AVG DAYS ON MKT

WHAT BUYERS LOVE

- **Historic Belle Meade** — classic estate streets like Tyne, Lynnwood, and Page Road.
- **Belle Meade Links** — smaller-footprint condos and townhomes for downsizers.
- **Highlands of Belle Meade** — newer enclave of transitional new builds.
- **Adjacent West Meade & Hillwood** — value plays with comparable schools.

DAVIDSON COUNTY · 8 MIN FROM DOWNTOWN

Green Hills

Sophisticated city living: dense walkable retail (The Mall at Green Hills), top public and private schools, and a mix of mid-century ranches, new modern builds, and luxury condos. The most 'urban' of the luxury submarkets.

\$1.9M

MEDIAN LUXURY

\$3.5M+

TYPICAL CEILING

\$565

PRICE / SQ FT

55 days

AVG DAYS ON MKT

WHAT BUYERS LOVE

- **Forest Hills** — 1 acre+ lots, mature trees, rebuild market is very active.
- **The Reserve at Green Hills** — luxury condo alternative for lock-and-leave buyers.
- **Hillwood / Hillsboro** — classic two-story traditionals with broad appeal.
- **Lipscomb / Vanderbilt corridor** — walkability to top universities and restaurants.

SECTION THREE (CONT.)

Estates, acreage, and the new frontier.

WILLIAMSON COUNTY · 35–45 MIN FROM DOWNTOWN

Leiper's Fork & Arrington

For buyers seeking 5 to 100+ acres, sweeping vistas, and meaningful privacy. Home to celebrity-grade compounds, equestrian properties, working farms, and the new Arbors at Leiper's Fork (22 gated homesites, 5–29 acres). Limited inventory; longer cycles; extraordinary lifestyle.

\$3.5M

MEDIAN LUXURY

\$12M+

TYPICAL CEILING

\$610

PRICE / SQ FT

95 days

AVG DAYS ON MKT

WHAT BUYERS LOVE

- **Leiper's Fork village** — historic farmhouses, art galleries, walkable Main Street.
- **The Arbors** — new gated estate development, homesites from \$925K.
- **Arrington / College Grove** — large-acreage estates, vineyards, equestrian.
- **Cottonwood & surrounding farms** — agricultural-zoned generational land.

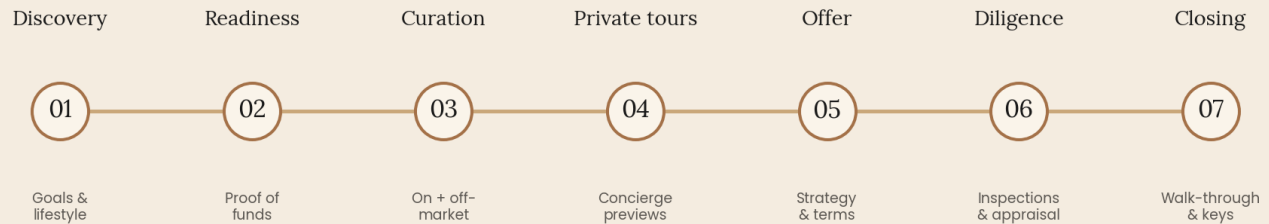
A NOTE FROM JASON

“Roughly one in three of my Leiper's Fork transactions never reaches the MLS. The best estates in Middle Tennessee change hands through relationships, not signs in yards. That's where the right representation pays for itself many times over.”

SECTION FOUR

The seven-step luxury process.

Every Nashville Luxury List engagement runs on the same disciplined framework. We move quickly, but never hurriedly — and we never let a single detail fall through the cracks.



01 · DISCOVERY

A one-hour private consultation. We clarify lifestyle, priorities, school requirements, timeline, and the deal structure that fits your broader financial picture. Outcome: a written buyer brief.

02 · FINANCIAL READINESS

Proof of funds, jumbo or portfolio lender pre-approval, and an introduction to my preferred lenders, CPAs, and wealth advisors if you don't have local relationships in place.

03 · CURATED HOME SEARCH

On-market listings filtered to your brief, plus active outreach to my network of agents, builders, and homeowners for off-market and coming-soon properties.

04 · PRIVATE TOURS

Concierge-scheduled showings — including evenings, weekends, and by helicopter if your time demands it. Builder walks for new construction.

05 · OFFER & NEGOTIATION

Pricing strategy backed by comp analysis, terms architecture, and a quiet, professional conversation with the listing agent to win on more than just dollars.

06 · INSPECTIONS & APPRAISAL

Specialty inspections for pools, septic, geothermal, smart-home tech, roofing, and structural elements. Appraisal coordination with your lender.

07 · CLOSING & CONCIERGE HANDOFF

Title, wire, walk-through, and a curated handoff to landscapers, interior designers, security, AV, and household staff if needed.

SECTION FIVE

Key considerations before you tour.

These are the issues I want every prospective luxury buyer thinking about *before* we walk through the first front door.

FINANCING & PROOF OF FUNDS

- Pre-approval from a jumbo or portfolio lender, ideally with private-banking relationship.
- Liquid proof of funds letter, refreshed within 30 days.
- Pre-cleared underwriting on assets if using a stock-backed line.
- If buying through an LLC or trust, formation documents ready for title.

DUE DILIGENCE & INSPECTIONS

- Specialty: roofing & flashing (slate, copper, standing-seam).
- Specialty: pool, spa, equipment shed, automation.
- Specialty: septic, well, geothermal, water filtration.
- Specialty: smart-home, AV, low-voltage wiring.
- Survey + boundary, easements, encroachments.
- Wood-destroying organism & moisture intrusion.
- Radon, mold, lead (for historic properties).
- HOA documents, CC&Rs, transfer fees.

NEGOTIATE BEYOND PRICE

- Furnishings & designer FF&E (often six-figure value).
- Art, fixtures, and chandeliers explicitly included.
- Flexible closing & lease-back terms.
- Repair credits vs. price reductions for tax purposes.
- Builder allowances, finish upgrades, or warranty extensions.
- HOA dues paid through year-end at seller's expense.

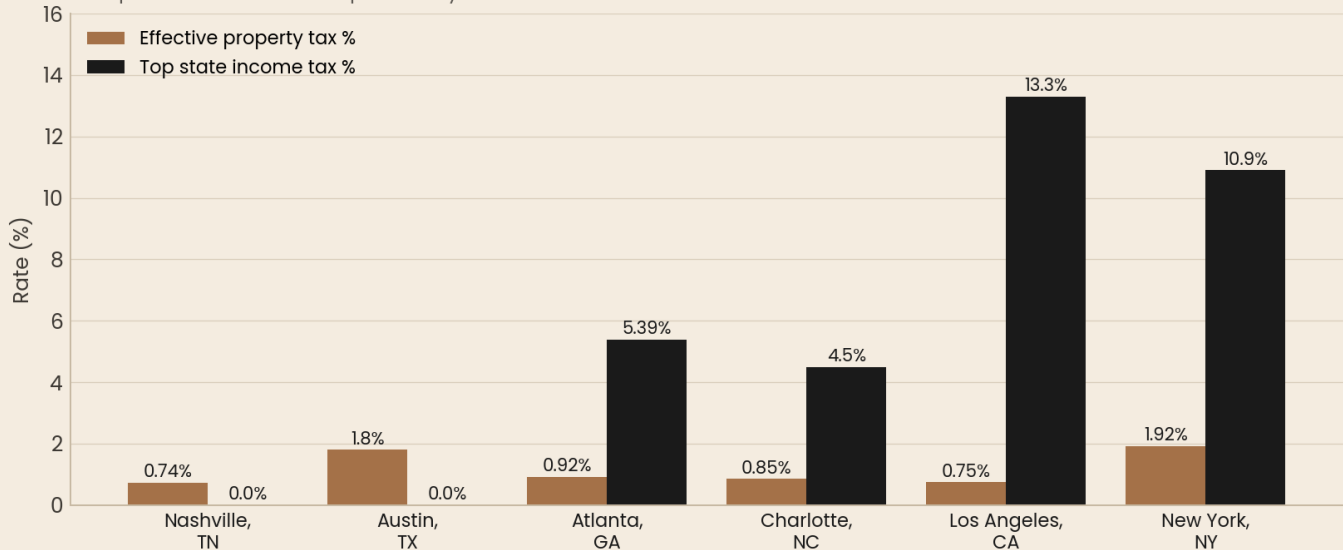
SECTION SIX

Tennessee's tax advantage.

Tennessee has no state income tax, no tax on wages, and no Hall tax on investment income (repealed 2021). For a buyer relocating from a top-bracket state, the annual savings often eclipse the cost of the move within the first year — and compound from there.

Tennessee's tax advantage, in two bars

Comparative tax burden vs. peer luxury metros



The compounding math: A household earning \$2M of W-2 + investment income relocating from California saves approximately \$266,000 in annual state income tax. Over a ten-year hold of a \$5M home, that's nearly \$2.7M of after-tax cash flow — before considering Tennessee's lower effective property tax and the absence of estate tax.

RELOCATION CHECKLIST

- Establish Tennessee domicile: driver's license, voter registration, vehicle titling.
- Update estate planning documents to TN law (a TN trust attorney referral is included).
- School admissions timing — private school decision deadlines run November–February.
- Coordinate moving company access; many gated communities require COI in advance.
- Set up utilities, HOA registrations, sticker decals for private clubs.
- Open accounts at a Tennessee-domiciled bank for closing-day wire convenience.
- Schedule a Nashville lifestyle day: schools, clubs, dining, route-planning.
- Engage household staffing & landscape teams (we maintain a vetted bench).

SECTION SEVEN

Trends shaping 2026.

What today's luxury buyer is asking for — and what tomorrow's buyer will expect when you eventually sell.

Transitional modern is winning.

The pure modern-farmhouse era is over. Buyers now want warm modernism: limestone, oak, copper, and limewashed brick framed in clean architectural lines.

Outdoor living is non-negotiable.

Pools, covered loggias, outdoor kitchens, and putting greens have moved from premium upgrade to baseline expectation in the \$3M+ band.

Wellness is the new amenity.

Cold-plunge rooms, saunas, IR rooms, gyms with sport floors, and lap pools are appearing in homes that would never have included them five years ago.

Builder + brand pedigree matters.

Castle Homes, Legend Homes, Tongue & Groove, Pfeffer Torode, and a handful of others command pricing premiums and resale loyalty.

Energy resilience.

Solar with battery backup, geothermal, EV charging at 80A, and generator transfer switches are now expected on \$5M+ new construction.

Private & off-market activity is rising.

Roughly a quarter of high-end transactions occur off-MLS. Your relationship with an active luxury advisor is your only meaningful access.

SECTION EIGHT

Why Middle Tennessee keeps outperforming.

Job growth that compounds.

Nashville added roughly 30,000 jobs in 2025 across healthcare, technology, music, and financial services. Oracle's East Bank campus and continued expansion from HCA, Asurion, AllianceBernstein, and others are reshaping the high-income workforce.

In-migration with purchasing power.

Roughly 26% of recent movers work remotely for out-of-state employers, with another 19% on hybrid schedules. Average household income for incoming residents is materially higher than for those leaving.

Cultural gravity.

Music, film, hospitality, and an unmatched live-music infrastructure draw creative capital. The Frist, Schermerhorn, Bridgestone, and a steady flow of festivals make Middle Tennessee a destination, not a layover.

Land scarcity around the urban core.

Belle Meade, Forest Hills, and Brentwood are largely built out. Williamson County zoning protects rural character. The supply of "new" truly luxury inventory remains structurally tight.

Tax & regulatory tailwinds.

No state income tax, comparatively low effective property tax rates, no estate tax, business-friendly statehouse, and a regulatory posture that favors investment.

A NOTE FROM JASON

"Nashville is no longer a secret. But the right house on the right street, bought at the right time, with the right team – that is still very much an inside game."

YOUR ADVISOR

Meet Jason Kloess.



Jason Kloess is a luxury real-estate advisor with Compass RE in Nashville and the founder of Nashville Luxury List — the area's go-to private resource for \$2M+ home buyers, sellers, and relocating families.

He represents clients across Davidson and Williamson counties, with particular depth in Franklin, Brentwood, Belle Meade, Green Hills, and Leiper's Fork. His practice is built around three principles: **experience** earned through hundreds of high-end transactions; **discretion** that protects the privacy his clients require; and **results** measured in off-market opportunities, clean terms, and seamless closings.

Jason works hand-in-hand with a vetted network of attorneys, lenders, builders, designers, and concierge providers — putting an entire white-glove team behind every transaction.

WHAT CLIENTS GET

- Access to exclusive off-market and coming-soon listings
- Vetted local builder, lender, designer, and concierge network
- Concierge-level guidance from first tour to closing day
- Seamless relocation assistance from out-of-state to settled

LET'S BEGIN

Experience. Discretion. Results.

Whether you are relocating, upgrading, or building a generational estate, every conversation begins privately — on your timeline, without obligation.

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